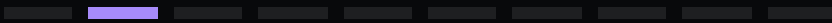


THE ECONOMICS OF AUTONOMY

**Nobody
budgets for the
expensive half.**

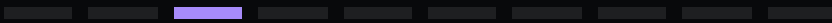
the build is not the expensive half



THE STAKES

**The build lands
on time. The
proving does not.**

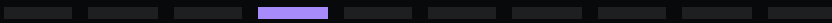
And the proving is what stands
between a working system and
one anybody will let near
production.



WHAT EVERYONE ASSUMES

**Cost scales
with how much
system there is.**

Four hundred components, four hundred things to verify. So the budget is drawn as a function of size, and it is drawn wrong.



THE BREAK

Verification attaches to the kind, not the instance.

Four hundred components are
rarely four hundred kinds of thing.
Prove the kind once, properly, and
every instance inherits it.



THE CURVE

400 → 15

Made-up round numbers, to show the shape. Cost stops scaling with how much you have and starts scaling with how many distinct mechanisms you have.

illustrative — not a measurement



WHY IT IS NOT FREE

Every special case is its own kind.

The moment one instance is patched differently it stops inheriting the proof, and you pay for it separately. Most systems are full of these. Almost nobody is counting them.



THE DISCIPLINE

Counting kinds is the actual work.

Not counting components —
anyone can do that. Establishing
that two things genuinely are the
same kind is where the saving
lives, and it is a design decision,
not an audit.



HOW TO PRICE IT

Never in money.

Money is the one input a funded buyer can always find. Price it in the scarcest thing: disciplines that must sit in one team simultaneously, and operating time that cannot be parallelised.



WHERE THIS STOPS WORKING

It assumes the kinds are stable.

If the mechanism set is still moving, you are paying to verify a moving target and the curve does not apply yet. Say so rather than claiming the saving early.

the argument has an edge, and this is it



THE TEST

**How many
kinds does your
system contain?**

Not components. Kinds. If you cannot answer within an order of magnitude, that is the finding.

count kinds, not parts